ISBA 4796-01: Capstone Proposal Development

Loyola Marymount University, College of Business Administration
Fall 2026

Format	In person
Credit hours	1
Scheduled slot	Tuesdays and Thursdays, 9:55 to 11:35 AM. We meet on Thursdays only, and not every Thursday.
Room	Hilton 106, every session. ISBA 3720 joins the two joint sessions on Zoom

Course description

This course starts your capstone. You leave with an approved capstone proposal, expressed as a product requirements document (PRD), a development environment and project repository, and enough Scrum to run the first sprint of ISBA 4797.

Two sessions are held jointly with ISBA 3720, Systems Analysis and Design, which also produces a capstone proposal. You can satisfy the proposal requirement through this course or through ISBA 3720.

You may work solo if your capstone is an internship you secure. Otherwise you work in a team.

Instructor

Professor Greg Lontok

Email	gregory.lontok@lmu.edu
Preferred contact	Microsoft Teams
Office	Hilton 114
Office hours	By appointment. Book at https://calendly.com/greg-lontok
Zoom room	https://lmula.zoom.us/my/lontok

Learning outcomes

By the end of this course you will be able to:

1. **Frame and validate a problem with a real stakeholder.** Gather and document their needs, confirm with them that you are serving the right person and solving the right problem, and define a measure of success that can be tracked from the outset.
2. **Produce a vetted capstone proposal, expressed as a PRD,** ready to carry into ISBA 4797.
3. **Explain your problem and proposed solution to someone unprepared,** without notes and on the spot.
4. **Apply Agile and Scrum methods,** including planning and running a sprint.
5. **Work in an AI-assisted development toolchain.** Set up Git, GitHub, and an AI coding agent, and explain the judgment behind what you accept from AI.

Instructional methods

The course meets eight times, always on a Thursday, in Hilton 106. Two of those sessions run jointly with ISBA 3720, which joins on Zoom. You also book one 15-minute individual meeting with me on Zoom in week 2.

Between sessions you work through asynchronous modules in Brightspace. That is where most of the reading happens. Three of our sessions work a single practice case, where I play the stakeholder and you interview me. The last three are your sprint: planning, a stand-up, and a review where every team presents to the others.

You work with an AI coding agent throughout, and you keep a research wiki that the agent maintains for you.

Required materials

The Scrum Guide is free at https://scrumguides.org/, and you will receive links to other online material.

The one thing you pay for in this course is a Claude Pro subscription for the AI coding agent. It is $20 a month. You need it in week 1, because the self-discovery interview is a Claude Code interview. Start it the week of Thu Sep 3 and cancel after the final PRD on Thu Dec 10. That is four billing months, or about $80. There is no student discount, and the annual plan bills $200 upfront, so monthly is the cheaper way to take one semester.

Required lab fees

None. LMU bills no lab fee for this course. You do pay for a Claude Pro subscription yourself, and required materials above explains what that costs.

Deliverables

- Self-discovery interview - the Markdown file from your 15-minute Claude Code interview, using the prompt at self-discovery-interview.md in this repository
- AI Dev Workflow Tutorial - your public repository URL, your live Streamlit dashboard URL, and your completed TASKS.md
- Scrum Open Assessment - your completed assessment from scrum.org
- Development environment and capstone repository - your team's repository URL, built from scratch, with your environment set up and your teammates added
- Stakeholder confirmation - written confirmation from your stakeholder that you are serving the right person, solving the right problem, and measuring the right thing
- Sprint cycle and review - nothing to upload. You are observed at sprint planning and at the stand-up, and you present live and take questions at the review
- Capstone wiki - your team's research wiki on your real project, in your capstone repository
- PRD - your problem brief and the PRD it becomes. You turn in a draft at the stand-up, and you present the final version at the sprint review

The first three are individual. The rest belong to your team, or to you alone if your capstone is an internship.

The capstone repository is not the tutorial. The AI Dev Workflow Tutorial at https://github.com/LMU-ISBA/ai-dev-workflow-tutorial is its own deliverable, and you work through it alone. It is where you learn the toolchain: Git, GitHub, an AI coding agent, and a Streamlit dashboard deployed to a live URL.

The capstone repository is your team doing it again but applied to your project. A repository named for your project, your teammates added to it, and a working environment set up from nothing.

Grading

A 950-point scheme. Your percentage is your earned points divided by 950, multiplied by 100. The percentages below are rounded to two decimal places.

Component	Points	%
Self-discovery interview	25	2.63
AI Dev Workflow Tutorial	150	15.79
Scrum Open Assessment	75	7.89
Development environment and capstone repository	100	10.53
Stakeholder confirmation	100	10.53
Capstone wiki	50	5.26
Sprint cycle and review	250	26.32
PRD	200	21.05
Total	**950**	**100**

Grade scale: A (93-100), A- (90-92), B+ (87-89), B (83-86), B- (80-82), C+ (77-79), C (73-76), C- (70-72), D (60-69), F (below 60).

Schedule

Week	Dates	We meet	Module	Due
1	Aug 31 to Sep 4	**Thu Sep 3, joint with ISBA 3720, in Hilton 106**	What the capstone expects of you, then this syllabus. You get the practice case. On your own: install Claude Code and start the self-discovery interview	none
2	Sep 7 to 11	**15-min individual meeting.** Book here.	Self-discovery, and the AI Dev Workflow Tutorial	Self-discovery interview (Tue Sep 8)
3	Sep 14 to 18	no	Scrum foundations: read the Scrum Guide	none
4	Sep 21 to 25	**Thu Sep 24, Hilton 106**	Framing a problem worth solving, and the interview it exposes	AI Dev Workflow Tutorial (Tue Sep 22)
5	Sep 28 to Oct 2	**Thu Oct 1, Hilton 106**	Discovery and stakeholder engagement	none
6	Oct 5 to 9	no	Scrum, continued: drilling the Guide	Scrum Open Assessment (Thu Oct 8)

Week	Dates	We meet	Module	Due
7	Oct 12 to 16	no	Working with an AI coding agent	none
8	Oct 19 to 23	no	Scope, non-scope, and success measures. Choosing your capstone project	**Internship secured (Thu Oct 22)**
9	Oct 26 to 30	**Thu Oct 29, Hilton 106**	Writing the PRD	none
10	Nov 2 to 6	no	Confirming with your stakeholder. User stories and estimation	none
11	Nov 9 to 13	**Thu Nov 12, joint with ISBA 3720, in Hilton 106**	Agile and Scrum in practice. Project briefs go out and teams form	**Projects assigned, teams form (Thu Nov 12)**
12	Nov 16 to 20	**Thu Nov 19, sprint planning, Hilton 106**	Planning your sprint	Dev environment and capstone repo, and stakeholder confirmation (Thu Nov 19)
13	Nov 23 to 27	no	Thanksgiving. Your sprint runs, but we do not meet	none
14	Nov 30 to Dec 4	**Thu Dec 3, stand-up, Hilton 106**	Running your sprint	PRD draft (Thu Dec 3)
15	Dec 7 to 11	**Thu Dec 10, sprint review, Hilton 106**	Closing your sprint, the retrospective, and handoff to ISBA 4797	Sprint review, capstone wiki, and final PRD (Thu Dec 10)

If you want to use an internship as your capstone, you have until Thu Oct 22 to secure one. If you do not have an internship by Oct 22, a project is assigned to you on Thu Nov 12.

Fri Sep 4 is the last day to add or drop without a W. Fri Nov 13 is the last day to withdraw.

Sprint meetings happen in our scheduled slot in Hilton 106, on Thu Nov 19, Thu Dec 3, and Thu Dec 10. Each team books a time within the slot for planning and the stand-up. The sprint review on Dec 10 works differently. Everyone stays for the whole slot, because the other teams are your audience. If your capstone is an internship you are working solo, you run your sprint on your own and meet me alone for planning and the stand-up, and you present at the review with everyone else.

Your individual meeting in week 2 is 15 minutes on Zoom. Submit your self-discovery interview first. Book at https://calendly.com/greg-lontok/15min

Work load expectations

This is a 1-unit course. Under LMU's credit hour policy that is about 45 hours across the term: roughly 15 hours of instruction, counting the asynchronous modules and your synchronous sessions, and 30 hours of your own work.

Across fifteen weeks that averages about 3 hours a week. Week 1's onboarding, the sprint weeks, and the last two weeks run heavier than the rest. Credit hour policy: https://academics.lmu.edu/aprc/lmucredithourpolicy/

Assignment submission

Assignments are submitted through Brightspace by the posted deadline. Late work loses 10% per day, down to a floor of 50%.

If you know you'll miss one, send me a Teams message before it passes. I may move it. That's case by case, and there's no bank of late days to spend. The new date is then the deadline, and the penalty runs from there.

No message before the deadline means no conversation after it, and the penalty runs from the original date.

Some assignments are delivered in person at a fixed time. Everything above applies to them, and the meeting time is the deadline.

Emergencies sit outside this too. Tell me when you're able and we'll make a plan.

Attendance

Your scheduled commitments are the eight sessions in the schedule above and your individual meeting in week 2.

If you feel ill, stay home. Rest, and keep everyone else healthy.

When you can't make one, send me a Teams message. Beforehand is best, and as soon as you can if something happens that morning. Late still beats silent.

Your first three absences cost you nothing if you told me. You don't owe me a reason and I won't ask for documentation.

An absence you never tell me about costs 2% of your total grade, and it still uses up one of the three. From the fourth on, each absence costs 2% whether you told me or not. That 2% comes off your final grade after everything else is totaled, so attendance is not a line in the grading table.

Some commitments are also graded work, and missing one costs you twice. The absence counts here like any other, and the grade is handled by the assignment submission policy.

Emergencies sit outside all of this. Serious illness, hospitalization, a death in the family: the three-absence count doesn't apply. Tell me when you're able and we'll work out a plan for the rest of the term.

The sprint review on Thu Dec 10 is not reschedulable except in a genuine emergency, and missing it scores zero. Your audience is the other teams, and they are in that room for it once.

How the course runs between sessions

Course materials, modules, and due dates are in Brightspace. Your project work lives in your own repository.

Between the eight sessions, Teams is the fastest way to reach me. Office hours are bookable at https://calendly.com/greg-lontok

You get feedback on each deliverable within one week of its due date. Feedback on the sprint cycle and the sprint review comes verbally at the meeting, and in writing within one week.

Engagement here looks like working through the module, showing up to the sessions you are committed to, and moving your proposal forward between them. If a deliverable does not arrive and I have not heard from you, I will reach out over Teams. In a course with this few contact points, a student can drift for weeks before anyone notices, so I would rather check in early and be wrong.

Use of technology and AI

You are expected to use AI in this course, including an AI coding agent.

What is assessed is your judgment, not just the output. Be ready to explain what you submitted, why you did it that way, and what you would do if a constraint changed. That is the whole point of the sprint review, and it is why work you cannot explain does not earn credit here.

ITS Service Desk: 310-338-7777 or 213-736-1097, servicedesk@lmu.edu, https://its.lmu.edu/servicedesk

Academic honesty

Academic dishonesty is treated as an extremely serious matter, with consequences ranging from no credit on an assignment, to failing the course, to expulsion. It is never permissible to turn in work you did not author, whether copied from another student or from a source, including the internet, without properly acknowledging that source.

In this course that most often means a proposal you cannot explain. Using AI is expected. Presenting AI output you do not understand as your own thinking is not.

LMU Academic Honesty Policy: https://academics.lmu.edu/honesty/

Accommodations

Students with special needs who require reasonable modifications, special assistance, or accommodations in this course should promptly direct their request to the Disability Support Services Office. Any student who currently has a documented disability, including ADHD, Autism Spectrum Disorder, learning, physical, or psychiatric, and needs academic accommodations should contact the DSS Office as early in the semester as possible.

DSS is in Daum Hall, 2nd floor, 310-338-4216. All discussions remain confidential.
https://academics.lmu.edu/dss/

Student support and reporting

Student support services: https://studentaffairs.lmu.edu/

Reporting sexual or interpersonal misconduct: https://studentaffairs.lmu.edu/lmucares/

To report an emergency or suspicious activity, contact LMU Public Safety at x222 or 310-338-2893, or use the nearest emergency call box. In an evacuation, follow the signage to the designated safe refuge area and wait for instruction from Public Safety or a Building Captain. https://www.lmu.edu/emergency

Tentative nature of this syllabus

If necessary, this syllabus and its contents are subject to revision. Changes will be announced through Brightspace and Teams, the same channels through which this syllabus was distributed, and you are responsible for any changes announced that way.

CBA mission

Advance knowledge and develop business leaders with moral courage and creative confidence to be a force for good in the global community.